

Chapter 99 - Kiss

Su Mo suddenly pulled her hand back and placed it in her sleeve, clenching it tight.

"Is it effective?" Ning Fuyi asked.

Su Mo bit her lip, mimicking Ning Fuyi's mouth movements, and tried calling "Yiyi" again. This time, apart from the tone sounding slightly strange, everything else was close to normal speech.

Ning Fuyi also became happy: "Exactly like that."

"I'll go get herbs for you." Su Mo hastily gestured, then got up, lifted her skirt hem, and rushed out the door.

Ning Fuyi watched her flee in panic, a smile still hanging on her face. Her phoenix eyes lowered slightly as she touched her lips, where the burning heat of the woman's fingertips seemed to still linger.

Feigning illness was indeed always effective no matter when. Ning Fuyi frowned as she adjusted her sitting position - it wasn't in vain that she endured the pain to keep the wound.

Since ancient times, schemes win hearts. Sometimes, using small tricks to achieve one's purpose is necessary.

After Su Mo took the medicine paste, she didn't return immediately. Instead, she stood at the foot of the mountain slope, letting the cool breeze blow on her for quite a while. Only when the lingering warmth on her face had dissipated did she dare return to the house.

Ning Fuyi was still leaning weakly against the soft pillow, her face turned slightly to one side, revealing her clearly defined jawline.

Su Mo's steps paused for half an instant before she crossed the threshold, uncovered the bamboo tube lid, and walked to the bedside: "The wound bandaging was too careless. Let me apply medicine for you again."

Ning Fuyi hummed in agreement, then sat up with Su Mo's support and turned her back to her.

The wound was on her back. Su Mo's hands trembled as she gripped the collar and pulled it down, revealing two rounded, fragrant shoulders. She absolutely didn't dare look elsewhere, only able to stare fixedly at that small blood-stained area, slowly unwinding the gauze.

When the gauze wrapped around to the front of the chest, she had to lean forward, as if enveloping the woman in her embrace. She quickly closed her eyes and only opened them when it wrapped back to the back.

In the past when her parents were still alive, regular customers often came to the door for consultations. At that time, she had helped examine several female patients, and even seeing everything didn't feel strange. But now...

Not to mention seeing her exposed, just being close to her made her feel like her insides were churning.

Su Mo grumbled inwardly, but her hands quickly unwound the gauze, revealing an extremely deep knife wound on her back. The gruesome flesh and blood imprinted on fragrant bones and soft skin looked very incongruous.

Su Mo couldn't help but make a small hissing sound as she applied medicine paste to the scar. Ning Fuyi seemed to be in pain, her slender neck extending slightly, straightening her waist like a snake.

This movement carried three parts allure no matter how you looked at it. Su Mo nearly trembled and spilled the medicine paste. She hastily applied the medicine in quick motions and rebandaged it.

After completing all this, Su Mo's back was soaked with sweat, making the pleasant spring March feel like scorching summer heat. She pulled up Ning Fuyi's top clothing, completely covering her body.

"Done." She gestured, then stepped back a large pace, creating distance between herself and Ning Fuyi.

When Ning Fuyi turned around, her gaze inadvertently swept across Su Mo's face. No matter how much Su Mo tried to appear calm, her skin that turned red at the slightest provocation couldn't deceive anyone.

"I'll go, make some, clear soup." Her fingers danced as she spoke haltingly, then nodded to Ning Fuyi and left again.

Rather than saying she left, it was more like she was escaping. Ning Fuyi reached out to touch the neat gauze, her pupils gleaming with satisfaction.

With two crisp snapping sounds, two figures appeared at Ning Fuyi's window. One looked completely disillusioned, the other covered her eyes while peeking through her fingers at Ning Fuyi, giggling incessantly.

"What are you laughing at?" Ning Fuyi protected her wound while half-leaning, half-sitting, looking up at Jiuying who was laughing until her whole body shook.

"I see you're like a wolf deceiving a little white rabbit, full of schemes everywhere, putting on quite a performance. It's fortunate that it's Su Mo here and not Chu Qingqiu, otherwise you would have been exposed hundreds of times already." Jiuying laughed until she was short of breath, using her hand to support her chest.

"Those little monsters in the demon cave should really come see this - see how their Demon Lord¹ acts all delicate and weak in front of his beloved, hmm~"

That nasal sound Jiuying made was seductive, earning her an eye roll from Ning Fuyi.

While the usually talkative Hannya hadn't spoken for a long while, her face flushed red, unable to believe that the Demon Lord she most worshipped actually had such a side.

Ning Fuyi didn't care what they thought, lazily tying her clothing belt: "Alright, stop watching the joke. I'm not really deceiving her - after all, the wound is genuine."

"Tsk tsk, you're really quite dedicated. If you couldn't win, just couldn't win - why insist on defeating that demon creature? Look, you're injured so severely. If I hadn't arrived in time to seal your immortal power, you probably would have had chaotic immortal meridians and fallen into demonic deviation." Jiuying walked to the bedside and sat down, wiping her sweat while continuing to nag.

"These few days you should just lie down properly and be a mortal." Jiuying squeezed her shoulder hard.

Ning Fuyi was squeezed until she drew in a sharp breath, shrinking away from her hand: "Who could have expected that Earth King² actually had some ability? But he could only suppress me because I'm at a cultivation bottleneck. If I had broken through to the Great Vehicle Realm³ early, I could have made him kneel in just a few moves."

"Easy to say - you still don't know why you have this bottleneck." Jiuying chuckled lightly. "Alright, rest now. Hannya and I will be nearby. If you need anything, just call me in your mind."

With that, she got up, grabbed Hannya by the back of her neck, and left together.

The room immediately became much quieter. Ning Fuyi carefully propped up her body, protecting her wound from being rubbed by her clothing, and lay down with difficulty.

Recovering from injuries as a mortal was truly troublesome - every movement brought heart-wrenching pain. Sure enough, scheming against others required paying a price. Ning Fuyi broke out in a cold sweat from the pain and drowsily closed her eyes to sleep.

Though the price was painful, the effect was immediate. Su Mo, who had previously avoided her and refused to see her, now seemed like a different person. She brought meals in the morning, and when she returned from gathering herbs on the mountain in the evening, she would help change her medicine, taking care of her with dedication. Although the two didn't often communicate, Ning Fuyi could feel that the atmosphere between them was becoming increasingly harmonious and tacit.

Ning Fuyi felt that in her thousand-plus years of life, apart from when Ning Changfeng⁴ was still alive, only now was her time of true peace. Each day she didn't need to think about other matters, rising with birdsong and resting with the evening wind.

And that figure she thought about day and night was right beside her - she could see her when she opened her eyes and think of her when she closed them.

Such days might be called the mortal world.

April brought the beginning of summer. The flowers covering the mountains and fields all bloomed overnight. From afar, colored mist drifted with waves of fragrance. Often bees and butterflies carrying flower nectar would fly through the window lattice, only to be waved away by Ning Fuyi.

The wound on her body had mostly healed, but the sealed immortal power hadn't been released yet. Ning Fuyi sat bored at the table, holding the flourishing gardenia flower⁵ and spacing out.

She hadn't taken it out to sunbathe for a long time, so the little flower was somewhat angry, its flower heart only facing away from her direction, refusing to turn around no matter what.

No matter how Ning Fuyi spun the glass cup into a whirlwind, the flower spun along with it into a blur.

Finally, Ning Fuyi compromised. She gently placed the glass cup on the table and coaxed in a soft voice: "It's my fault for forgetting about you these past few days. I'll cry a bit later to let you drink your fill. How about that?"

The little flower was still very angry. Now even its leaves were somewhat wilted, each leaf trying hard to avoid Ning Fuyi's hand and not let her touch it.

"Chu Qingqiu must have given all her temperament to you, this one soul." Ning Fuyi helplessly poked its stem.

"Ouch." She quickly withdrew her hand, looking at the tiny blood mark on her fingertip with a mixture of tears and laughter. "You're a gardenia, not a rose. How come you prick people?"

As she was coaxing it, she heard footsteps outside the door. She quickly put the glass cup back into the Thought Pearl⁶ and sat up straight.

The one who opened the door was indeed Su Mo. She came in breathlessly carrying a basket, clearly having just returned from gathering herbs on the mountain. Her dress was still stained with grass leaves, her shoes were soaked with mud and grass juice, and her whole body carried the fresh scent of mountain forests.

Her expression was joyful, her ten fingers flying: "Today, I dug up extremely delicious taro. I'll cook it for you."

Seeing this, Ning Fuyi quickly got up and reached out to take the heavy basket from her: "You've been tired all day. Let me prepare today's meal."

Su Mo shook her head repeatedly. She removed her face veil, revealing her smiling face: "No, I'll cook for you."

With that, she picked out several mud-covered taro from the basket and hurried to the kitchen.

The sleeve warmed by the sun was pulled from Ning Fuyi's hand, seeming to come alive and making her heart itch. Ning Fuyi withdrew her hand, holding back her smile.

Su Mo's figure busied about in the courtyard for a long time, then the whole courtyard filled with fragrance. Ning Fuyi followed the scent outside and saw several bowls already placed on the table, with chopsticks washed bright and clean.

The small courtyard, the roses, the low table, the steaming hot food, and the vast fields and distant mountains outside the courtyard.

When this scene fell into her eyes, a sense of satisfaction arose spontaneously, as if she had wandered in circles and finally found something called home in a corner of the mortal world.

Su Mo beside her handed her chopsticks, saying hoarsely: "Yiyi, eat."

She could now say some words and phrases. Though halting, they were already understandable.

"You must be exhausted." Ning Fuyi lovingly wiped the sweat from her face. Su Mo shook her head, her ears secretly turning red again.

They sat down to eat, accompanied by the evening breeze full of flower fragrance. Even the coarse grain and wild vegetables in their mouths tasted very sweet.

"Yesterday you learned 'help me,' how about we learn another word today?" Ning Fuyi put down her bowl and chopsticks.

"What?" Su Mo's eyes were full of expectation.

"Get, lost." Ning Fuyi mouthed the words.

Su Mo's willow brows rose as she hit Ning Fuyi's hand with her chopsticks.

"I'm not teasing you - these words are very useful!" Ning Fuyi laughed as she dodged, saying seriously, "If you encounter any annoying rascals in the future, use these words to scold them."

Ning Fuyi repeated it again. Only then did Su Mo reluctantly make sounds: "Pot, lid."

"Get, get, lost, lost." Ning Fuyi opened her mouth wide.

This time Su Mo said it with some resemblance. She covered her face and said it several more times. The birthmark on her face seemed to truly bloom, beautiful under the evening glow.

Ning Fuyi was momentarily lost in thought, but was soon interrupted by several strange sounds. It seemed like some enormous creature was running from the distance, causing the earth to shake.

Ning Fuyi suddenly stood up, only to see a shadow instantly leap over the courtyard wall. Beast roars combined with a bloody maw crashed into the small courtyard.

Su Mo was initially at a loss, but after seeing the creature's appearance clearly, she immediately screamed and retreated in panic. However, that thing was coming straight for her, charging forward without explanation and extending claws sharp as daggers to pounce at her.

This was terrible! Ning Fuyi's vision went dark, because the visitor was none other than Bai Lin⁷, who had been desperately searching for its master!

Which damned person hadn't been watching it properly, letting it run here alone! Ning Fuyi quickly jumped in front of Bai Lin, reached out to grab the fur under its arms, and held it back with all her might.

"Su Mo! Go back to your room quickly!" Ning Fuyi turned and shouted to Su Mo, then extended her right foot into the soil, using her body to block Bai Lin while scolding quietly in its ear, "Bai Lin, Chu Qingqiu doesn't recognize you now. Leave quickly. If you scare her to death, you'll be a beast guilty of harming your master!"

However, Bai Lin was desperate with longing for its master and couldn't hear what she was saying. Its four giant claws frantically thrashed about, making whimpering sounds from its throat.

But its appearance was truly rough, and in Su Mo's eyes, it looked like angry roars of something about to devour people, frightening her until tears streamed down her face.

The two things she feared most in life were vengeful spirits and ghosts, and the other was these fierce large beasts. Her parents had been devoured by such creatures without even bones remaining, with only a few bloody finger fragments found.

Now seeing this thing again - could it be that the calamity from ten years ago had found her again, wanting to exterminate her completely?

She trembled like a sieve here, while Ning Fuyi could no longer hold on over there. Unfortunately, her immortal power was sealed, so she couldn't handle a crazed divine beast. She was knocked flying by Bai Lin's claw and fell at Su Mo's feet.

Ning Fuyi cursed every profanity in her mind. With no other choice, she prepared to forcibly break through the seal. However, when her hand seal was only half-formed, she saw a weak figure crawling and tumbling toward her. That figure was obviously scared nearly to unconsciousness, yet still tried to extend her arms, like a protective eagle bird sheltering her under her wings.

"Get! Lost!" Su Mo shouted with her eyes closed, her crying voice mixed with bravery instantly froze Ning Fuyi, her heart in chaos like scattered pearls⁸, emotions scattered all over the ground.

Bai Lin only listened to Chu Qingqiu's words. Now it stopped in confusion, its huge round head carefully approaching forward, making rough whimpering sounds.

Su Mo screamed "get lost" again. Bai Lin covered its face with its claws, stumbling backward. Its bottom crashed into the courtyard wall and it even tripped.

Finally, it crawled and rolled as it got up, sadly running away.

Seeing the white tiger disappear, Su Mo's accumulated courage completely vanished. Her legs went soft and she collapsed onto Ning Fuyi, frantically turning to check her wounds, tears falling like raindrops.

"How are you? Are you injured?" She wiped her tears while gesturing intermittently, her eye sockets red as the blooming skull flower⁹.

Ning Fuyi watched her panic in silence, her heart in unbearable turmoil. She reached out to hold her flailing hands, tilted her neck up, and aimed for her moist lips to kiss them.

Author's Note: Bai Lin: Hehe, at the crucial moment you still have to rely on me, Old Bai!!

Footnotes:

1. **Demon Lord (魔尊)** - A title indicating the highest ruler or leader among demons/demonic cultivators, showing Ning Fuyi's true identity and status in the demonic realm.
2. **Earth King (地王)** - A powerful demon/monster that Ning Fuyi fought and was injured by, demonstrating the dangerous threats in this cultivation world.
3. **Great Vehicle Realm (大乘)** - One of the higher cultivation realms in the established power system, representing advanced spiritual cultivation.
4. **Ning Changfeng (宁长风)** - Mentioned as someone important from Ning Fuyi's past who brought her peace when alive, likely a family member or mentor.
5. **Gardenia flower (梔子花)** - The flower that contains Chu Qingqiu's soul fragment, representing the connection between the past and present incarnations.
6. **Thought Pearl (一念珠)** - A magical storage item that can hold objects in a dimensional space, commonly used by cultivators.
7. **Bai Lin (白麟)** - Chu Qingqiu's divine beast companion, a white tiger-like creature that serves as her mount and protector.
8. **Scattered pearls (璎珞)** - Referring to scattered prayer beads or jewelry, used as a metaphor for chaotic emotions.
9. **Skull flower (骷髏花)** - A specific type of flower mentioned earlier in the story, likely with dark or ominous associations, used here to describe the intense red color of Su Mo's emotional state.